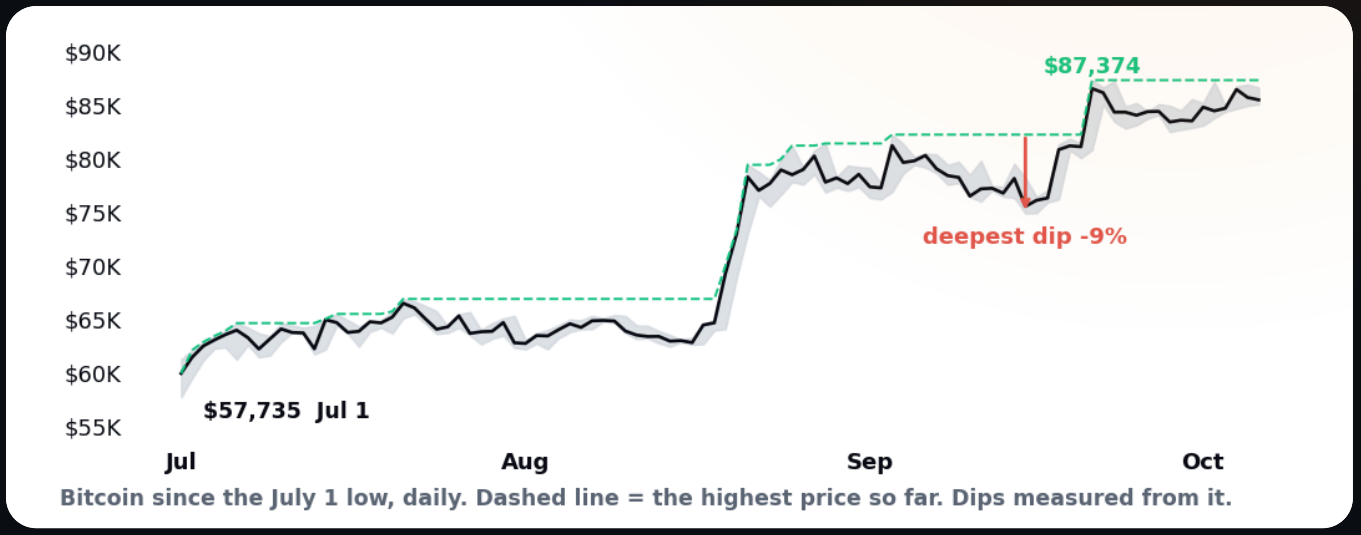
THE UP ONLY STUDY

It feels like Bitcoin can only go up. 98 days after the July 2026 low it has not had a single 10% pullback. I checked every run in Bitcoin's history since 2012.

How calm this run really is, the longest calm runs ever, where they happened, how far they went, how every one of them ended, and what came after.



Bitcoin since the July 1 low, daily. Dashed line = the highest price so far. Dips measured from it.

98 days
from the July low without a 10% pullback

3rd
longest calm run since 2012

0.3%
of 98-day stretches were this calm

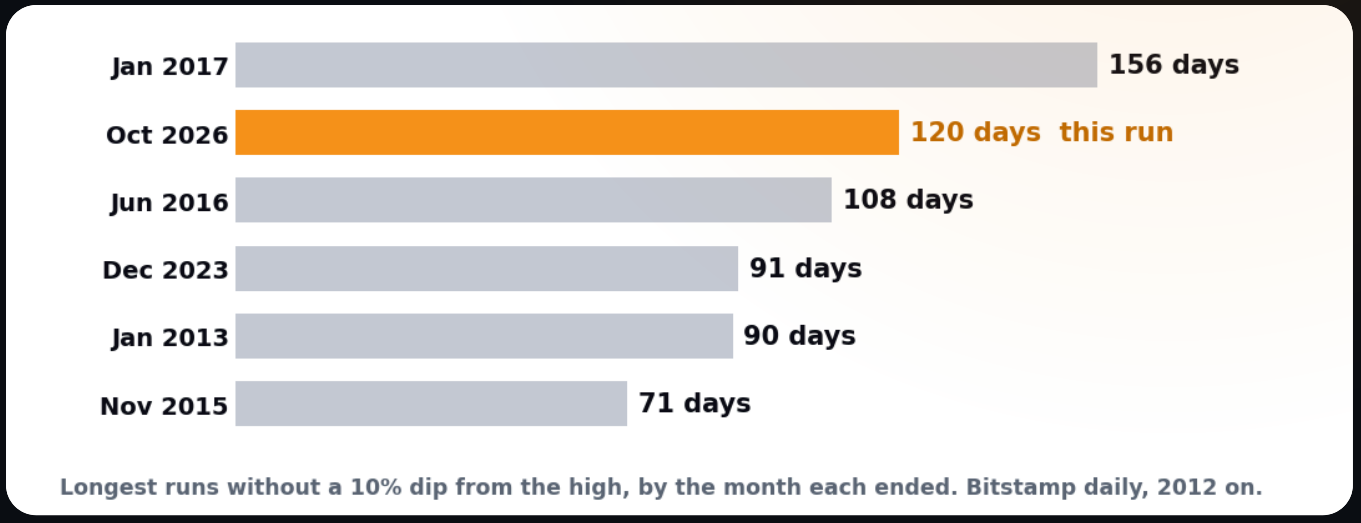
Educational, not financial advice. A pullback here is a day's low against the highest price before that day, on Bitstamp daily wicks, so a crash day's own range never counts.

Bitcoin Jae
@bitcoin.daily

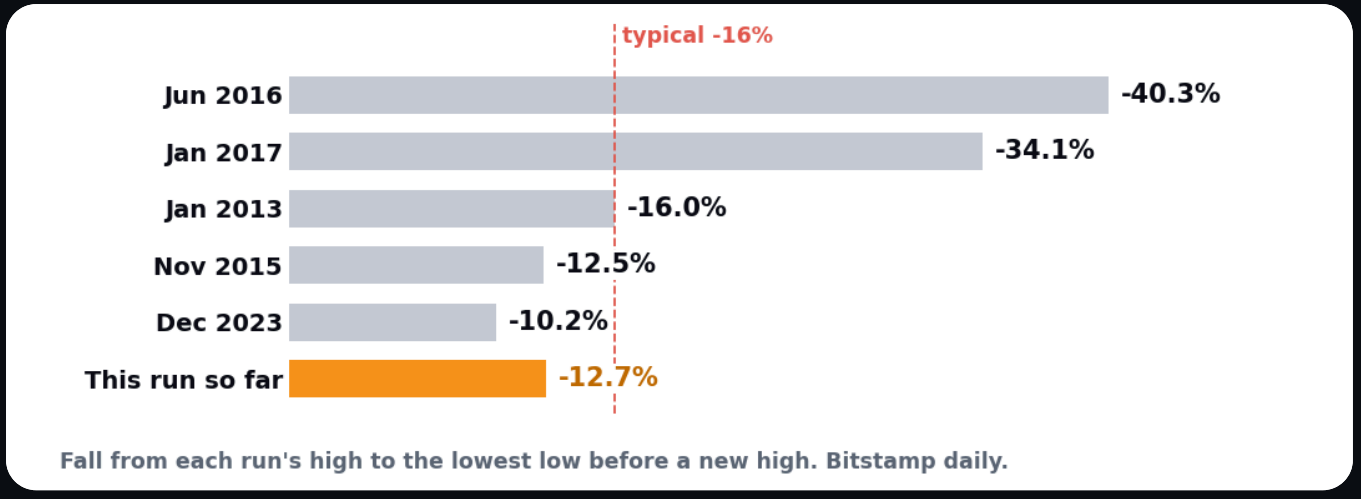
UPDATE, 30 OCTOBER 2026

THE RUN ENDED

This study was written on day 98. On 29 October the run ended at 120 days, when Bitcoin fell through $78,636, 10% under the $87,374 high. It finished as the second longest run without a 10% dip since 2012. The low so far is $76,320, down 12.7% from the high. The rest of this guide is pinned to 6 October, as it was first published.



Longest runs without a 10% dip from the high, by the month each ended. Bitstamp daily, 2012 on.



Fall from each run's high to the lowest low before a new high. Bitstamp daily.

RUN ENDED	DAYS	FALL FROM ITS HIGH	6 MONTHS AFTER THE END
Jan 2017	156	-34.1%	+159%
Jun 2016	108	-40.3%	+20%
Dec 2023	91	-10.2%	+69%
Jan 2013	90	-16.0%	+414%
Nov 2015	71	-12.5%	+9%

The five longest runs before this one. All five started more than a year after the last cycle top. This one started 268 days after the top, so the same outcome is not guaranteed.

THIS RUN

HOW CALM IS THIS?

From the $57,735 low on 1 July 2026, Bitcoin reached $87,374 on 21 September, +51%. The deepest pullback along the way was -9.0%, on 15 September. Every dip of 4% or more is below.

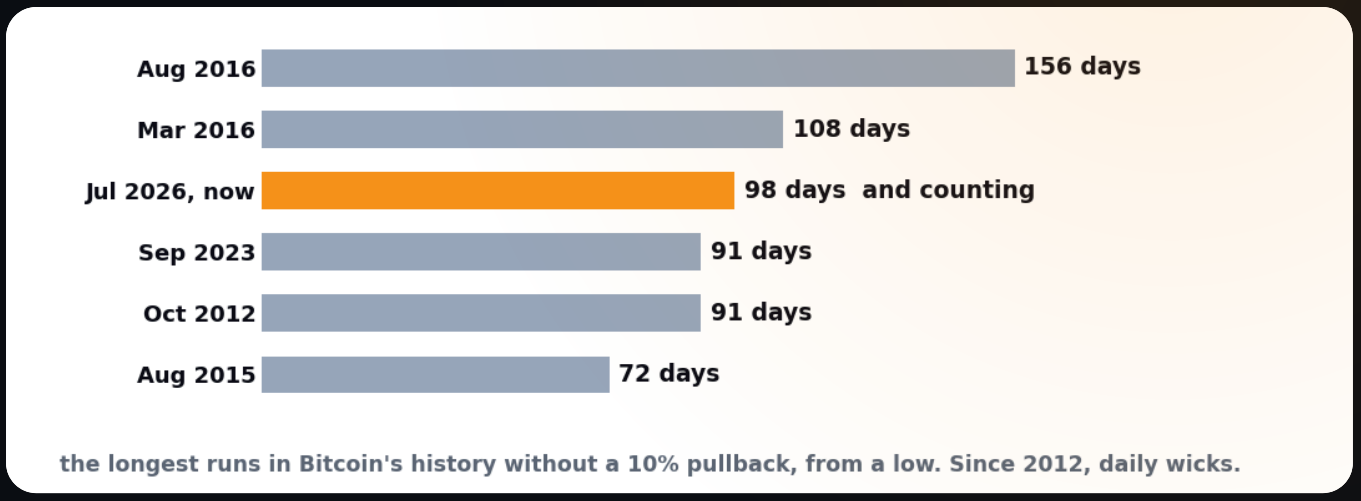
DIP LOW	FROM THE HIGH	TO	PULLBACK
08 Jul	$64,657	$61,481	-4.9%
17 Jul	$65,518	$62,470	-4.7%
03 Aug	$66,921	$62,216	-7.0%
23 Aug	$79,461	$75,568	-4.9%
15 Sep	$82,281	$74,913	-9.0%
28 Sep	$87,374	$82,555	-5.5%

Each dip measured from the highest price before it. Bitstamp daily wicks.

Across every 98-day stretch since 2012, the typical one had a 32% pullback somewhere inside it. Only 15 of 5,295 stretches, 0.3%, stayed as calm as this one. They came in 2016, in 2023 and now.

HISTORY

THE LONGEST CALM RUNS



the longest runs in Bitcoin's history without a 10% pullback, from a low. Since 2012, daily wicks.

RUN BEGAN	DAYS	GAIN TO ITS HIGH	PULLBACK THAT ENDED IT	6 MONTHS AFTER IT ENDED
Aug 2016	156	+145%	-34%	+159%
Mar 2016	108	+104%	-40%	+20%
Sep 2023	91	+79%	-10%	+69%
Oct 2012	91	+98%	-16%	+414%
Aug 2015	72	+103%	-13%	+9%
Oct 2024	70	+84%	-18%	+8%
Sep 2020	65	+60%	-10%	+297%
Apr 2012	60	+39%	-10%	+103%
Jun 2025	60	+27%	-14%	-40%

Every run of 60 days or more from a low without a 10% pullback, since 2012. The pullback is measured from the run's high to the low before the next new high.

WHERE

CALM RUNS COME AFTER BOTTOMS

All nine of these runs came after a bear market had already made its final low. 2012 came after the 2011 low, 2015 and 2016 after the January 2015 low, 2020 after the 2018 low, and 2023 to 2025 after the 2022 low. Not one happened between a cycle top and that bear's final low.

After past bear lows, the first rallies were sold fast. After the last three, the first 10% pullback came on day 2 (2015), day 10 (2018) and day 28 (2022), and the first 20% pullback on day 13, day 44 and day 108. The 2026 run has gone 98 days without either.

READ THIS CAREFULLY

This is the strongest point the study makes for July 1 being the bottom, and also the reason to be careful. Every calm run like this one belongs to a recovery that had already started. Either 2026 is one, or it is the first calm run inside a bear.

HOW FAR

HOW HIGH THE CALM RUNS WENT

RUN BEGAN	GAIN TO ITS HIGH	THAT GAIN FROM THE JULY 2026 LOW
Aug 2016	+145%	$141,450
Mar 2016	+104%	$117,779
Aug 2015	+103%	$117,201
Oct 2012	+98%	$114,315
Oct 2024	+84%	$106,232
Sep 2023	+79%	$103,345
Sep 2020	+60%	$92,375
Apr 2012	+39%	$80,251
Jun 2025	+27%	$73,323

Each run's gain from its low to its high, applied to the $57,735 July low. A comparison, not a target.

Seven of the nine went higher than +51% before the pullback came. The typical run, the median, reached +84%, about $106,000 from the July low. The two runs that lasted longer than this one, both in 2016, were +60% on day 98 and went on to +104% and +145%.

HOW THEY END

EVERY CALM RUN ENDED

None of the nine ended quietly. The pullback that ended them ran from 10% to 40% from the run's high. In dollars from the $87,374 high, the same range looks like this.

PULLBACK	FROM $87,374	WHEN IT HAPPENED
-10%	$78,636	the smallest pullback that ended a calm run
-16%	$73,394	Jan 2013
-34%	$57,667	Jan 2017, back to the July low
-40%	$52,424	Jun to Aug 2016, below the July low

Six months after each run ended, Bitcoin was higher eight times out of nine. The exception was the summer 2025 run, which ended in August 2025, about six weeks before the cycle top. Six months later Bitcoin was 40% lower.

The limits. Nine runs is a small sample, they overlap in time with each other's bull markets, and 2012 traded on a thin market. A run is defined by one threshold, 10%, and moving it changes the list. None of this says when the current run ends, only how past ones did.

Data pinned 6 October 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily bars. Scripts: UpOnly/uo_study2.py, UpOnly/uo_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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This is the kind of breakdown I do every day. The hype brings the noise. I bring the data.

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